

Chapter 28-4

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When Liang Shi was rescued, she first spat out two mouthfuls of water, her whole body weak and powerless.

She leaned weakly against Xu Qingzhu's shoulder, while Xu Qingzhu wiped the water from her face and laid her flat.

With such a big incident happening, almost all the Liang family members came out.

Except for Qiu Zimin, who was playing mahjong in the room.

Liang Xinhe looked at the weakly collapsed Liang Shi, crouched down to pat her face, and anxiously called: "Liang Shi, Liang Shi."

"Second brother, please step aside." Xu Qingzhu said: "I'll perform CPR on her."

She clasped her hands together and began pressing on Liang Shi's chest.

Press after press, Liang Shi kept spitting out water.

She was completely soaked, her long hair lying wet on the ground. As an Alpha, she looked particularly disheveled.

After she had vomited up all the water accumulated in her abdomen, she planned to slowly regain consciousness.

The original owner couldn't swim, but Liang Shi could.

She would never gamble with her life against others.

This time was just to scare Zhou Yi'an.

She had seen Liang Xinhe and Xu Qingzhu coming out of the banquet hall, so she timed her jump perfectly.

Because Liang Xinhe had been a swimming champion in high school and almost made it to the provincial team.

But she hadn't expected that the person who jumped in to save her would be Xu Qingzhu.

For an Omega whose body hadn't fully recovered to drag an Alpha who was taller and larger than her out of the water, even with the help of water's buoyancy.

It was still an exhausting task.

And Xu Qingzhu was anxiously performing CPR on her, which somewhat disrupted Liang Shi's plan.

So she vomited out more of the water she had deliberately swallowed earlier, shortening the time to save Xu Qingzhu some effort.

Just as she was about to open her eyes, Xu Qingzhu had already pinched her nose and began performing mouth-to-mouth resuscitation.

"....."

An Omega's lips were very soft, having just come out of the water, carrying a wet coolness.

She gave her a large breath of air.

Liang Shi's hand hanging to one side suddenly clenched the hem of her skirt.

Xu Qingzhu single-mindedly performed mouth-to-mouth resuscitation, her lips falling and leaving again and again.

On the third time, Liang Shi coughed a few times as Xu Qingzhu pulled away, then slowly opened her eyes.

Even though her composure was disrupted by Xu Qingzhu's actions and she felt somewhat flustered, she could still force herself to finish this performance.

After opening her eyes, she looked around, and when she saw Zhou Yi'an, fear flashed in her eyes, then she shook her head: "Don't... don't kill me."

Everyone: ".....?"

Well, this was quite a revelation.

Before Liang Shi fell into the water, everyone thought it was just a dispute between the two, so Zhou Yi'an pushed Liang Shi into the water.

But Liang Shi's first words upon waking were looking at Zhou Yi'an and saying, "Don't kill me"?

What kind of grudge was this?

"Who wants to kill you?" Liang Xinhe asked coldly: "Don't be afraid."

Liang Shi shook her head: "Can't... can't say..."

She began coughing, holding onto Xu Qingzhu's hand, coughing continuously until she almost coughed up her lungs. When she raised her head again, her face was flushed, several strands of hair still disheveled, but she didn't look ugly—rather, she had a tragic beauty.

She said in a hoarse voice, weak: "If I tell... our family won't be able to... participate in the south city land bid."

She spoke intermittently, but could make every person present hear clearly.

An actor's vocal training was being displayed to its fullest at this moment.

Having been polished in front of cameras for many years, Liang Shi already knew which of her expressions were beautiful, what actions could evoke people's empathy.

She did neither more nor less, showing Liang Xinhe a weak smile: "Second brother, I'm... cough cough... I'm fine."

Liang Xinhe was already furious, looking at Zhou Yi'an.

The crowd watching the drama were very moral, clearing out the space around Zhou Yi'an.

Liang Xinhe roared: "Zhou Yi'an, you're truly lawless! No matter how much power you have, this is a society ruled by law—murder requires paying with one's life! Do you really think the Liang family is a soft persimmon¹ for you to squeeze at will? If my sister had died here today, I would definitely make you pay with your life!"

"She..." Zhou Yi'an looked at Liang Shi, who flashed her a victorious smile, but only for an instant before immediately returning to her weak and pitiful state.

Zhou Yi'an swallowed back the words she was originally going to say: "She fell in herself, believe it or not."

No one would believe it.

Liang Shi had calculated well.

Everyone saw her reach out and push Liang Shi.

No one would believe that Third Miss Liang, who couldn't swim, would bet her life against someone.

Liang Shi was quite crazy too.

Zhou Yi'an sneered coldly and answered Liang Xinhe: "Isn't she still alive?"

"If she had died, you would be dead now too." Liang Xinhe said.

Zhou Yi'an: "Oh."

"Second brother, don't... don't blame Miss Zhou." Liang Shi said: "Miss Zhou kept pressing me about where Cheng... Cheng Ran is. I don't know, so she got angry and acted."

Everyone: "....."

So there was another layer to this?

"It's my fault for being useless." Liang Shi's voice was still intermittent, sounding very labored, but she could accurately deliver every word to the ears of everyone present: "I couldn't help Miss Zhou..."

Someone in the crowd said: "This is too domineering, wanting to kill someone over a small disagreement."

Zhou Yi'an's expression changed slightly.

When someone led the narrative, others quickly followed suit.

"Exactly, the Zhou family doesn't have this kind of family culture. I've met the eldest Miss Zhou before—a very gentle and virtuous young lady."

"The Zhou family wasn't in Haizou City in previous years. They just moved back not long ago. Mr. Zhou has been lax in discipline, usually too indulgent with this youngest daughter, which has cultivated such a spoiled temperament."

"Third Miss Liang isn't exactly a pushover either, but today she was bullied like this."

"Does Mr. Zhou know his daughter is so arrogant outside? She's ruining all the good reputation he's built up over the years."

"Mr. Zhou is honest and upright, most just and fair, usually decisive and stern, but he just can't handle this youngest daughter."

"But you can't let her continue like this. She's bound to cause trouble eventually."

"Isn't today already causing trouble? Third Miss Liang almost died."

"....."

They seemed to be whispering among themselves, but actually every word they said could be heard by Zhou Yi'an.

Zhou Yi'an had already clenched her fists.

What did these people understand?

How could she bully Liang Shi?

It was clearly Liang Shi who, taking advantage of her affection, kept pressing and bullying her.

But everyone looked at Third Miss Liang with sympathy, all sighing.

She looked like she was down to her last breath, quite pitiful.

Liang Shi had achieved her goal and was ready to faint at any moment.

But she felt that if she fainted now, her Omega wife might want to carry her back.

Helplessly, she could only cough weakly: "So... so cold."

"Quickly." Liang Xinhe ordered: "Go back inside."

A nearby waiter immediately came to help her, and Xu Qingzhu also lent a hand to support Liang Shi.

Liang Shi wanted Xu Qingzhu to leave with her, but Xu Qingzhu only let the waiter accompany her while staying behind herself.

Footnotes:

¹ Soft persimmon - A Chinese idiom meaning someone who is weak and easily bullied or taken advantage of.

Author's Note: [If any author's notes were present in the original text, they would be translated here]